

PCB-01 · BODY OF KNOWLEDGE — EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

The Project Controls Body of Knowledge — executive summary

What the thirteen domains cover, and what a credential built on them does and does not assert

VERSION 1.0 · DRAFT

2026-08-04

PROJECT CONTROLS INSTITUTE GLOBAL, INC.

AI proposes. The professional disposes.

— Summary

The Project Controls Institute's Body of Knowledge is a thirteen-domain, sixty-one-knowledge-area statement of what a project controls professional must know, weighted forty per cent project accounting and finance, forty per cent project management principles and twenty per cent AI. This summary explains what the framework claims, how the examination samples from it, what the PCL-AI credential therefore asserts about a holder, and the four things it deliberately does not assert.

— About this document

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The Project Controls Body of Knowledge — executive summary

In one paragraph. The Project Controls Institute's Body of Knowledge is a thirteen-domain, sixty-one-knowledge-area statement of what a project controls professional must know, weighted forty per cent project accounting and finance, forty per cent project management principles and twenty per cent AI. This summary explains what the framework claims, how the examination samples from it, what the PCL-AI credential therefore asserts about a holder, and the four things it deliberately does not assert.

Who this is for. Project controls managers, cost engineers, planners and commercial managers deciding whether to certify; and the heads of function, PMO leads and hiring managers who will read the credential on someone else's application.

— 1. What the Body of Knowledge is

The Body of Knowledge is the published statement of what the Institute holds a project controls professional must know, structured so that it can be studied, examined and argued with. It is thirteen domains, subdivided into sixty-one knowledge areas, each of those divided into numbered topics on the pattern `Domain.KA.Topic` — so `6.3.1` is an address, not a page number. The numbering is the working part. An examination item, a revision plan, a competency assessment and a complaint that something was tested unfairly can all name the same location and mean the same thing.

It is not a textbook of one organisation's method, nor a rival to the frameworks already in use. Where a body of practice exists — the PMBOK Guide, AACE's Total Cost Management framework, ISO 31000, the Scrum Guide, the IFRS standards — the Body of Knowledge names it, explains its principle in the Institute's own words, and says where a practitioner must exercise judgement instead. It reproduces none of them. What it adds is not another method but an **integration**: the claim that the finance, delivery and AI material belong in one competent head rather than three adjacent ones.

The full framework runs to roughly a million characters of manuscript and is not republished in this series. What follows is the argument, not the content.

— 2. The claim underneath it: one discipline, not three

Most certification frameworks in this space certify a slice. A planning credential certifies logic and float; a cost credential certifies estimating and earned value; an accounting qualification certifies recognition and reporting. Each is defensible, and each leaves a seam. The number that reaches the board has crossed all three: physical progress becomes earned value, earned value becomes a forecast, the forecast becomes the percentage complete that determines recognised revenue, and the revenue becomes the profit the market sees.

The Institute's position is that the seam is the discipline. Someone who can compute a cost performance index but cannot say what their revised estimate at completion does to reported revenue is not half-competent; they are competent at a task and not at the job. [PCB-03 – Why 40/40/20 defends that claim in full.](#)

— 3. The architecture in one view

Three groups carry the framework: **project accounting and finance** (Domains 1–4) at forty per cent, **project management principles** (Domains 5–12) at forty per cent, and **AI knowledge and practical approach** (Domain 13) at twenty per cent. Weights attach to groups, never to individual domains, and no per-domain percentage is published. The domain-by-domain map is [PCB-02 – The thirteen domains at a glance.](#)

Two features are easy to miss. AI is not confined to Domain 13: every non-AI domain carries embedded coverage of how AI assists that subject and where it must not be trusted, and the twenty per cent is measured across that whole surface. And the domains are sequenced so later ones re-use earlier machinery rather than restating it — agile is authored after earned value because it re-uses the same arithmetic on variable scope, and the AI domain last so its workflows can cross-reference the domains they operate on.

— 4. What sampling from it means for the examination

The examination is built backwards from the framework, not assembled from good questions. Every form meets the same specification: all thirteen domains sampled at the published group weights, in four-option multiple-choice items with a single best answer, tagged recall, application or analysis and deliberately weighted towards the latter two. The sitting runs ninety minutes. No formula sheet is provided — selecting the right formula is part of what is assessed. Scoring is criterion-referenced, not graded on a curve.

Two numbers a reader will look for are absent, deliberately. **There is no published item count:** item counts will be confirmed by a formal job-task analysis with practitioners, and until that runs the honest answer is that the number does not exist. **The pass mark is not finally set:** the platform is configured at sixty-five per cent, and the definitive standard will be set by a modified-An-goff standard-setting study — a documented judgement about what a minimally competent professional must demonstrate rather than a round number chosen for pass-rate optics. Both are stated here rather than smoothed over, because a candidate who discovers them later will reasonably feel misled. [EXB-01 – Examination blueprint – PCL-AI](#) has the full treatment.

— 5. What the PCL-AI credential asserts — and its four limits

A PCL-AI holder has demonstrated, at a single sitting, competence against a published framework at a published standard. The substance of that assertion — the propositions a holder is claiming to be able to act on — is set out in [PCB-04 – What a project controls professional must know.](#)

Four limits belong in the same breath.

It is a point-in-time assessment, not a warranty of practice. Valid for three years and maintained through continuing professional development including a mandatory AI-currency component. It says what was demonstrated, not what is being done today.

It is not accreditation. The framework is developed with reference to ISO/IEC 17024 personnel-certification principles. PCI is **not accredited** by ANAB, IAS or any other ISO/IEC 17024 accreditation body, holds no governmental approval and claims no university equivalence. The Institute is at step one of a published four-step path — standard defined, then candidate enrolment, then accreditation, then recognition — and says so.

It certifies knowledge and judgement, not outcomes. Nothing here predicts a salary, a promotion or a project result, and PCI makes no representation about any of them.

It is separate from membership. PCI membership grades — Student, Associate, Professional, Fellow — are a different ladder. A credential is earned by examination; a grade is a standing. Conflating them is the most common error in describing PCI, and it is worth an employer's attention on a CV.

— 6. What the Body of Knowledge deliberately excludes

A framework is defined as much by its boundary as its contents, and three exclusions are load-bearing.

No jurisdiction's law or tax treatment is presented as universal. Where accounting, legal or tax treatment varies by country, the framework teaches the principle and says that it varies. No candidate is assessed on one country's rule.

No vendor's tool is examined. Scheduling, cost and analytics software change faster than a certification cycle. The framework examines the method — a forward and backward pass computed by hand, a forecast method selected against the cause of a variance — because that survives the tool.

No blueprint exists yet for the sibling credentials. The Institute certifies three credentials at Leader level: PCL-AI in project controls, PFL-AI in project finance and PML-AI in project management. This Body of Knowledge and its blueprint are **PCL-AI only**; no blueprint, weighting or item specification exists yet for the other two, and any document implying otherwise is wrong.

— 7. Where the framework is unfinished

Every domain is a first authored draft pending subject-matter-expert review, and the appendices are assembled from finished domains. The job-task analysis that will validate the sampling has not run. The first edition's effective date is [\[CONFIRM: first-edition effective date for the PCL-AI Body of Knowledge\]](#). [PCB-05 – How the Body of Knowledge was built](#) sets out the standard the material has already passed and the gates ahead of it.

Publishing the unfinished parts is a choice with a cost. A framework that will govern other people's careers should be arguable before it is binding, and a reader who can see which parts are settled is better placed to challenge the parts that are not. If a domain misses something the job requires, the Institute would rather hear it now than defend it later.

— 8. How this goes wrong

The most damaging misreading treats a domain title as a subject boundary. Domain 6 is not "the earned value questions": earned value logic appears inside contract, schedule, risk and agile scenarios, because that is where it appears at work, and examination scenarios cross domains deliberately. The second — reading the group weights as a study-time rule — is treated in [PCB-03 – Why 40/40/20 §8](#), along with the other three ways a weighting is misread.

— Related

- [PCB-02 – The thirteen domains at a glance](#) — the printable map of all thirteen domains and sixty-one knowledge areas
- [PCB-03 – Why 40/40/20 – the weighting and what it claims](#) — the argument this summary asserts and does not defend
- [PCB-04 – What a project controls professional must know](#) — the propositions the credential asserts about a holder
- [PCB-05 – How the Body of Knowledge was built](#) — the authoring, review and evidence standard behind the material
- [PCB-06 – Using the Body of Knowledge: a guide for employers](#) — role design, hiring and development built on the framework
- [EXB-01 – Examination blueprint – PCL-AI](#) — how the framework becomes an examination form

— Sources and standards

- PCL-AI Body of Knowledge, first authored draft, thirteen domains and sixty-one knowledge areas ([docs/bok/](#)), August 2026. Authored under the credential's retired code; the credential is now PCL-AI.
- The Style Spine — Conventions of This Reference ([docs/bok/00-style-spine.md](#)), August 2026: the authoring standard, domain map and 40/40/20 weighting.
- Examination Blueprint ([docs/downloads/examination-blueprint.md](#)), August 2026: group weights, item format, cognitive levels, formula policy, standard-setting commitments.
- PCI Canonical Facts ([docs/publication-framework/00-framework/CANONICAL-FACTS.md](#)), verified August 2026: credential codes, examination configuration, accreditation wording, membership grades.

Standards named in this document — the PMBOK Guide, AACE's Total Cost Management framework, ISO 31000, ISO/IEC 17024, the Scrum Guide and the IFRS standards — are named as frameworks the Body of Knowledge references and explains in its own words. No edition, clause or wording is cited here, because no edition was verified for this summary; the Body of Knowledge itself names them at the point of use.

— Status and version

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PCB-02 · BODY OF KNOWLEDGE — EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

The thirteen domains at a glance

The full map — thirteen domains, sixty-one knowledge areas,
three group weights

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PROJECT CONTROLS INSTITUTE GLOBAL, INC.
AI proposes. The professional disposes.

— Summary

The complete map of the PCL-AI Body of Knowledge on one page: thirteen domains, sixty-one knowledge areas, and the three published group weights of forty, forty and twenty per cent. Each domain is given the question it answers and the knowledge areas that answer it, so a reader can locate any topic by number and see what sits either side of it.

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The thirteen domains at a glance

In one paragraph. This is the complete map of the PCL-AI Body of Knowledge on one page: thirteen domains, sixty-one knowledge areas, and the three published group weights of forty, forty and twenty per cent. Each domain is given the question it answers and the knowledge areas that answer it, so a reader can locate any topic by number and see what sits either side of it. It is a reference card, not an argument.

Who this is for. Candidates planning revision, controls managers auditing what their function covers, and anyone who has been told the framework is broad and wants to see exactly how broad.

— 1. How to read the map

Every topic sits at a numbered address on the pattern **Domain.KA.Topic**. Knowledge Area 6.3 is the estimate-at-completion family inside the earned value domain; **6.3.1** is a topic within it. Cite the number rather than repeating the content — that convention lets an examination item, a revision plan and a coverage complaint all name the same place.

Weights attach to the three **groups**, not to individual domains: there is no published per-domain percentage and no per-domain passing requirement. A domain with six knowledge areas is not worth more than one with three; the counts reflect how much distinct material a subject contains, not how heavily it is sampled.

— 2. The map

Group (weight)	#	Domain	KAs
Project accounting & finance (40 %)	1	Foundations of Accounting for Project Controls	5
	2	Financial Reporting & the Standards	5
	3	Budgeting & Forecasting	5
	4	Performance Management, Variance Analysis & Management Reporting	4
Project management principles (40 %)	5	Cost Management & Cost Control	4
	6	Earned Value Management & Forecasting (EVM/EAC)	4
	7	Contracts, Commercial Management, BoQ, Invoicing & Revenue	5
	8	Project Management Lifecycle	6
	9	Agile, Scrum & Adaptive Delivery for Project Controls	6
	10	Project Scheduling	4
	11	Business Process Cycles (O2C, P2P & the control environment)	3
	12	Risk Management for Project Controls	3
AI knowledge & practical approach (20 %)	13	AI for Project Controls & PM: Concepts, Tools & Practice	7
Total	13 domains		61

— 3. Group one — project accounting and finance (Domains 1-4)

Domain 1 • Foundations of Accounting for Project Controls (5 KAs). Where do the numbers I report actually come from? A controls professional does not keep the books but reads and reconciles against them daily. The knowledge areas are the accounting model (1.1), the components of the financial statements and how they articulate (1.2), accrual accounting and the matching concept (1.3), cost provisions and accruals under IAS 37 (1.4), and the chart of accounts and cost coding that connects a posting to the work breakdown structure (1.5).

Domain 2 • Financial Reporting & the Standards (5 KAs). Which number is recorded, and when? Domain 1 gives the mechanics; this gives the rules. The reporting framework (2.1); IFRS 15 revenue from contracts with customers, the flagship knowledge area (2.2); revenue recognition beyond the basics, including principal-versus-agent and bundling (2.3); the other standards a controls professional meets — inventories, property, leases, borrowing costs (2.4); and management reporting versus statutory reporting (2.5).

Domain 3 • Budgeting & Forecasting (5 KAs). What did we say it would cost, and what do we now say? Budgeting fundamentals including the two kinds of reserve (3.1); cost estimation and its accuracy classes (3.2); the time-phased cost baseline that becomes Planned Value (3.3); forecasting and the estimate-at-completion family (3.4); and cash-flow forecasting — the difference between a project being profitable and being funded (3.5).

Domain 4 · Performance Management, Variance Analysis & Management Reporting (4 KAs). Does any of this change a decision? Performance management principles, including leading versus lagging indicators (4.1); variance analysis that decomposes a gap into price, quantity, rate and efficiency causes so the right lever is pulled (4.2); management reporting designed for an audience and a decision (4.3); and data visualisation and storytelling that informs rather than distorts (4.4).

— 4. Group two — project management principles (Domains 5-12)

Domain 5 · Cost Management & Cost Control (4 KAs). What is committed, not just what is spent? The cost management framework (5.1); the commitment-to-accrual-to-actual control cycle (5.2); the cost breakdown structure and control accounts (5.3); and change control and cost impact, where baselines are most often quietly lost (5.4).

Domain 6 · Earned Value Management & Forecasting (4 KAs). How much have we done, what did it cost, and what will it cost to finish? EVM fundamentals and the methods of measuring earned value (6.1); variances and performance indices (6.2); forecasting with the estimate-at-completion family (6.3); and integrating cost and schedule, including EVM's limitations and the earned-schedule refinement (6.4).

Domain 7 · Contracts, Commercial Management, BoQ, Invoicing & Revenue (5 KAs). Who bears the overrun, and when do we get paid? Contract types and their risk allocation (7.1); contract management across the lifecycle — variations, claims, liquidated damages, retention, bonds (7.2); bills of quantities and how work is measured and priced (7.3); invoicing and applications for payment (7.4); and revenue recognition in the commercial cycle, tying billing back to the over- and under-billing position (7.5).

Domain 8 · Project Management Lifecycle (6 KAs). Where does controls work sit in the wider job? The five process groups — initiating (8.1), planning (8.2), executing (8.3), monitoring and controlling (8.4), closing (8.5) — then development approaches: predictive, iterative, incremental and adaptive (8.6), including the incremental-versus-iterative distinction that is most often confused.

Domain 9 · Agile, Scrum & Adaptive Delivery for Project Controls (6 KAs). How do I measure work whose scope is meant to change? Agile foundations (9.1); the Scrum framework in depth (9.2); backlogs, estimation and agile metrics — velocity, burndown and burnup, flow (9.3); Kanban, Lean and scaling (9.4); agile cost control, forecasting and earned value on variable scope (9.5); and hybrid delivery and agile governance (9.6).

Domain 10 · Project Scheduling (4 KAs). When will it happen, and what has slack? Schedule development — activities, dependencies, durations (10.1); network analysis and the Critical Path Method, worked end-to-end through the forward and backward pass (10.2); schedule compression and resourcing, covering crashing, fast-tracking and levelling (10.3); and progress measurement and schedule control (10.4).

Domain 11 · Business Process Cycles (3 KAs). Which transaction created this number? Order-to-cash (11.1); procure-to-pay (11.2); and internal control and segregation of duties, including the three-way match and the audit trail (11.3). The shortest domain in the framework and among the most load-bearing: where the accounting of Domains 1-2, the cost control of Domain 5 and the commercial cycle of Domain 7 meet the daily transaction flow.

Domain 12 · Risk Management for Project Controls (3 KAs). Where does the range around every forecast come from? The risk framework, including appetite and tolerance (12.1); the risk

process — identify, analyse qualitatively and quantitatively, respond, monitor (12.2); and contingency and management reserve, which turns quantified risk into budget and closes the loop back to Domain 3 (12.3).

— 5. Group three — AI knowledge and practical approach (Domain 13)

Domain 13 · AI for Project Controls & PM (7 KAs). What can I responsibly let a machine do? AI foundations for professionals (13.1); data, the fuel that governs every AI outcome (13.2); prompting and working with generative AI (13.3); AI tool categories for controls and project management (13.4); AI applied across the controls lifecycle, the largest knowledge area, carrying the systematic per-domain workflows (13.5); governance, ethics, risk and assurance (13.6); and building an AI-augmented controls capability (13.7). The governing principle throughout is the Institute's: AI proposes; the professional disposes.

— 6. What the map does not tell you

It does not give you a per-domain weight. Coverage is spread within each group across its member domains and their knowledge areas. Any figure claiming a percentage for a single domain did not come from the Institute.

It does not confine AI to Domain 13. Every non-AI domain carries embedded coverage of how AI assists its subject and where it must not be trusted, and knowledge area 13.5 carries the systematic per-domain treatment. Governed-AI judgement can appear inside an item sitting in any group.

It does not tell you where the examination will press. Scenarios cross domains deliberately: a schedule slip carries cost, risk, commercial and reporting consequences, and one item may require all four.

It does not tell you where to spend your time. That depends on your gaps. A cost engineer from an accounting background typically under-prepares Domains 8-10; a planner typically under-prepares Domains 1-4. The map is the same for both; the revision plan should not be.

— Related

- [PCB-01 – The Project Controls Body of Knowledge – executive summary](#) — what the framework claims and what the credential asserts
- [PCB-03 – Why 40/40/20 – the weighting and what it claims](#) — why the groups carry the weights shown in §2
- [PCB-04 – What a project controls professional must know](#) — the propositions this map exists to support
- [EXB-01 – Examination blueprint – PCL-AI](#) — how the map becomes an assembled examination form
- [EXB-02 – Domain weightings and the 40/40/20 rule](#) — the sampling mechanics behind the group weights

— Sources and standards

- PCL-AI Body of Knowledge, first authored draft ([docs/bok/](#)), August 2026: domain and knowledge-area headings, and each domain's stated scope and learning objectives.
- The Style Spine ([docs/bok/00-style-spine.md](#)), August 2026: §2, the Domain.KA.Topic numbering convention; §11, the thirteen-domain map.
- Examination Blueprint ([docs/downloads/examination-blueprint.md](#)), August 2026: §2, the domain table, group weights and the two notes on reading it.

Standards named in the domain descriptions above — IFRS 15, IAS 37 and the Critical Path Method among them — are named as subjects the Body of Knowledge treats. Their principles are explained in the framework's own words at the point of use; no standard's text, table or clause is reproduced here or there.

— Status and version

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Why 40/40/20 — the weighting and what it claims

The argument for putting forty per cent of a controls credential on finance and twenty per cent on AI

VERSION 1.0 · DRAFT
2026-08-04

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— Summary

A certification weighting is an argument about a job, not an allocation of pages. This document sets out why the PCL-AI puts forty per cent of the examination on project accounting and finance, forty per cent on project management principles and twenty per cent on AI — with a worked example showing how a controls professional's forecast decision moves reported revenue — and states plainly what evidence would change the weighting.

— About this document

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Why 40/40/20 — the weighting and what it claims

In one paragraph. A certification weighting is an argument about a job, not an allocation of pages. This document sets out why the PCL-AI puts forty per cent of the examination on project accounting and finance, forty per cent on project management principles and twenty per cent on AI — with a worked example showing how a controls professional's forecast decision moves reported revenue — and states plainly what evidence would change the weighting.

Who this is for. Practitioners deciding whether the framework describes their job, heads of controls functions judging whether it describes their team's, and anyone who thought the finance share too high or the AI share too low.

— 1. What a weighting is a claim about

Three groups carry the framework: project accounting and finance at forty per cent, project management principles at forty per cent, AI knowledge and practical approach at twenty. The domains inside each are mapped in [PCB-02 – The thirteen domains at a glance](#).

Those three numbers are the most consequential editorial decision in the credential: a weighting determines which competence a pass certifies and which it merely brushes. Publish one and you have committed to a view of the job that can be tested against practice and, if wrong, held against you. The Institute's position, labelled as the Institute's: **project controls, cost engineering and project finance are one discipline, and the boundary between them is where projects are lost**. The 40/40/20 split is that claim expressed as an examination.

— 2. Why finance is forty per cent

The usual objection is that controls professionals do not do accounting; accountants do. True, and beside the point. The controls professional does not record the entry — they originate the input that determines it. On a long-term contract accounted for over time by the cost-to-cost input method, the percentage complete driving recognised revenue is costs incurred against total expected costs. Total expected costs is the estimate at completion, and the estimate at completion is a controls output. That is how revenue arises in project-based businesses: the forecast defended in a monthly review lands, largely unaltered, in the profit the board reports.

The second reason is symmetrical. Without the finance half the controls half cannot be checked: actual cost is a ledger extract, and knowing whether it is complete means knowing whether the accruals were raised and the commitments captured. Cost variance computed on incomplete actuals is not a small error — it is a favourable one, the most dangerous kind.

— 3. Worked example — one forecast decision, two revenue numbers

Illustrative figures. One fixed-price contract accounted for over time under the cost-to-cost input method; currency USD, data date end of month 9. Money to the nearest whole unit, ratios to two decimal places, percentages to one — all computed from unrounded values.

Given. Contract price 12,000,000 · Budget at Completion (BAC) 10,000,000 · Planned Value (PV) 6,300,000 · Earned Value (EV) 6,000,000 · Actual Cost (AC) 5,700,000 · billed to date 6,400,000.

Step 1 — the controls position. Under budget, behind plan.

$CPI = EV \div AC = 6,000,000 \div 5,700,000 = 1.05$ $SPI = EV \div PV = 6,000,000 \div 6,300,000 = 0.95$ $CV = EV - AC = 6,000,000 - 5,700,000 = 300,000$ favourable $SV = EV - PV = 6,000,000 - 6,300,000 = (300,000)$ adverse

Step 2 — the index-based forecast, and what it does to revenue.

$EAC = BAC \div CPI = 10,000,000 \div 1.0526... = 9,500,000$ $VAC = BAC - EAC = 10,000,000 - 9,500,000 = 500,000$ favourable $Progress\ (cost-to-cost) = AC \div EAC = 5,700,000 \div 9,500,000 = 60.0\%$ $Revenue\ recognised\ to\ date = 60.0\% \times 12,000,000 = 7,200,000$ $Contract\ asset\ (unbilled) = 7,200,000 - 6,400,000 = 800,000$

$AC \div EAC$ came out at exactly the same 60.0 per cent as $EV \div BAC = 6,000,000 \div 10,000,000$. That is not a coincidence of these figures but an identity: where the estimate at completion is the index-based $BAC \div CPI$, then $AC \div EAC = AC \div (BAC \times AC \div EV) = EV \div BAC$, whatever the numbers. The accountant's percentage complete and the controls professional's are one calculation that two professions have been taught to name differently.

Step 3 — the forecast the practitioner actually defends. The index-based forecast assumes past cost performance continues. Suppose the control account managers' bottom-up estimate to complete puts the remaining work at 4,500,000, the favourable variance having come from early scope now finished.

$EAC = AC + ETC = 5,700,000 + 4,500,000 = 10,200,000$ $Progress = AC \div EAC = 5,700,000 \div 10,200,000 = 55.9\%$ $Revenue\ recognised\ to\ date = 55.9\% \times 12,000,000 = 6,705,882$ $Contract\ asset\ (unbilled) = 6,705,882 - 6,400,000 = 305,882$

The consequence. Substituting the bottom-up estimate for the index-based forecast moved recognised revenue from 7,200,000 to 6,705,882 — a reduction of 494,118, or $494,118 \div 12,000,000 = 4.1\%$ of the contract price. Nothing about the work changed. One judgement about the cost of the remaining scope changed the number the board reports.

Assumptions the answer depends on. A single performance obligation satisfied over time; no variable consideration or constraint in play; transaction price unchanged at 12,000,000; the two estimates at completion the only variable between the cases. Which method to use is itself a judgement, treated in [BPG-09 – Estimate at completion – choosing and defending a method](#).

— 4. Why project management is forty per cent and not sixty

Eight of the thirteen domains sit in the project management group — cost control, earned value, contracts, lifecycle, agile, scheduling, process cycles and risk — and on knowledge-area count it is

much the larger, thirty-five of sixty-one. It carries the same forty per cent, and this is the harder half of the argument.

The delivery group is weighted for what the professional must originate: the schedule logic, the measured progress, the committed cost, the quantified risk. The finance group is weighted for what they must stand behind, which requires comparable depth because the consequences are less visible and arrive later. A schedule error announces itself; a recognition error waits for an audit. Sixty per cent on delivery would reproduce a credential the market already has several of.

— 5. Why AI is twenty per cent, and not a chapter

Twenty per cent is deliberately uncomfortable in both directions.

Against a token chapter. AI now sits in the tooling of estimating, forecasting, document review, risk identification and reporting, and a professional who cannot judge an AI-produced forecast will either rubber-stamp it or refuse it — both failures of competence. AI proposes; the professional disposes, and disposing requires knowing what the model was given, what its output is sensitive to, what it cannot know and what a human must verify. A single chapter cannot carry a competence exercised weekly.

Against a larger share. Twenty per cent is also a ceiling, set there because AI in project controls is a governed application of the other twelve domains, not a replacement for them. Someone who prompts fluently but cannot compute an estimate at completion by hand has no basis on which to disagree with the machine.

The share is measured across the whole AI surface — every non-AI domain carries embedded coverage of governed AI use in its subject, and knowledge area 13.5 the systematic per-domain treatment. It will also age faster than the other two, as it should.

— 6. Why the weights attach to groups and not to domains

The Institute publishes three weights, not thirteen. Weighting each domain would imply a precision the evidence does not support: no defensible study has established that scheduling is worth 6.5 per cent of a controls professional's competence and process cycles 3.5 per cent. Group weights claim only what can be defended, and they protect candidates from a false optimisation — no domain is small enough to skip safely, and there is no per-domain passing requirement to game.

— 7. What would change the weighting

A position that cannot be falsified is not worth publishing. Three things would move this one.

A job-task analysis that contradicts it. A formal job-task analysis with practising professionals will validate the blueprint's sampling against the work the credential attests. If practitioners' actual task frequencies and criticality do not support a forty per cent finance group, the weight changes and the reason is published. Timing: [\[CONFIRM: date the job-task analysis reports, and whether it confirms the 40/40/20 group weights\]](#).

Evidence that the finance share is not discriminating. If item analysis after the first sittings shows the finance group failing to separate competent from not-yet-competent candidates, it is

testing recall rather than the judgement described in §2 — and the fix is item quality before it is weighting.

A material change in what AI does. If the judgement a professional must exercise over AI outputs broadens, the share rises; if verification becomes routine rather than skilled, it falls. Either way the change is published with its reason, and candidates are assessed only against the edition in force for their sitting.

— 8. How this goes wrong

As a study budget. The weights describe the paper, not your gaps; a planner weak on accounting should spend well over forty per cent of revision on Domains 1–4. **As a statement of workplace value.** Forty per cent examination weight is not forty per cent of a controls professional's week — sampling weights the knowledge a decision depends on, not the hours a task consumes, and the correct employer use is [PCB-06 – Using the Body of Knowledge: a guide for employers](#). **As a per-domain requirement.** There is no minimum score per domain and no published per-domain percentage; results carry a domain breakdown for diagnostic value, but the pass decision is made on the whole paper against one criterion-referenced standard. **As a prediction of where AI appears.** Governed-AI judgement sits inside items in any group, because that is where it sits at work.

— Related

- [PCB-01 – The Project Controls Body of Knowledge – executive summary](#) — the framework this weighting governs
- [PCB-02 – The thirteen domains at a glance](#) — which domains sit in which group
- [PCB-04 – What a project controls professional must know](#) — the propositions the weighting is designed to certify
- [EXB-02 – Domain weightings and the 40/40/20 rule](#) — how the group weights become a sampled examination form
- [EXB-06 – Job-task analysis: where the blueprint gets its authority](#) — the study that will test this weighting
- [BPG-09 – Estimate at completion – choosing and defending a method](#) — the judgement made in §3, treated in full

— Sources and standards

- PCL-AI Body of Knowledge, first authored draft ([docs/bok/](#)), August 2026: Domain 2 on revenue recognition and the cost-to-cost input method; Domain 3 on the cost baseline; Domain 6 on the earned value measures, indices and the estimate-at-completion family; Domain 7 on billing and the contract asset position; Domain 13 on governed AI use.
- The Style Spine ([docs/bok/00-style-spine.md](#)), August 2026: §1, the 40/40/20 weighting and the rule that the AI share is measured across the whole AI surface rather than one chapter.
- Examination Blueprint ([docs/downloads/examination-blueprint.md](#)), August 2026: §2, weights attach to groups not domains; §5, the job-task analysis and standard-setting commitments.

IFRS 15 is named as the standard governing revenue from contracts with customers, and the cost-to-cost input method is described in the Institute's own words. No standard text, table or clause is reproduced, and no edition is cited, because none was verified for this document. The worked example in §3 is illustrative and represents no real contract, organisation or project.

— Status and version

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PCB-04 · BODY OF KNOWLEDGE — EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

What a project controls professional must know

Eleven propositions the Body of Knowledge asserts, and what each one is evidenced by

VERSION 1.0 · DRAFT
2026-08-04

PROJECT CONTROLS INSTITUTE GLOBAL, INC.
AI proposes. The professional disposes.

— Summary

The Body of Knowledge is a syllabus; the credential is a claim. This document states that claim as eleven propositions about what a project controls professional must be able to do, gives the concrete test behind each one, names where it sits in the framework, and states plainly what is not being claimed.

— About this document

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What a project controls professional must know

In one paragraph. The Body of Knowledge is a syllabus; the credential is a claim. This document states that claim as eleven propositions about what a project controls professional must be able to do, gives the concrete test behind each one, names where it sits in the framework, and states plainly what is not being claimed.

Who this is for. Practitioners deciding whether to certify, controls managers assessing their own team, and interviewers who want a better question than "tell me about your earned value experience".

— 1. Why propositions and not a syllabus

A syllabus lists what is covered. A claim states what a holder can do, in terms specific enough to be wrong. The eleven below are written to be falsifiable: each names something a professional either can or cannot do, with a test attached. Where a proposition is a rule it says so; where it is a judgement it says so too, because that difference is most of what separates a competent professional from a well-trained one.

There are eleven propositions across thirteen domains and no one-to-one correspondence — several draw on three or four domains at once. They are also not the PCL-AI competency set, which is fourteen named competencies treated in [CMP-03 – PCL-AI: the fourteen competencies](#). The propositions are what those competencies look like when someone is doing the work.

— 2. The eleven propositions

1. Read the ledger your numbers come from. Not keep the books — read them. Know which posting created a figure, which account it landed in, how the cost code maps to the work breakdown structure element you report against, and how the statements articulate. Test: given a cost report that disagrees with the general ledger by a material amount, name three plausible causes before opening anything. Where: Domain 1 (KAs 1.1, 1.2, 1.5), Domain 11 (KA 11.3).

2. Know when cost and revenue land, and recognise an obligation before anyone invoices it. The accrual and matching concepts are not accounting trivia; they decide which period a variance appears in. A professional who reports on invoices received is reporting last month. Test: explain the difference between an accrual and a provision, and say which one an anticipated contract loss is. Where: Domain 1 (KAs 1.3, 1.4 — IAS 37), Domain 2 (KA 2.5).

3. Build an estimate with a stated accuracy class, and phase it into a baseline earned value can measure. An estimate without a stated class and basis is an opinion with decimal places. A budget that has not been time-phased is not a baseline — it is a total. Test: state the estimating method used, its accuracy class, and the three assumptions the number is most sensitive to. Where: Domain 3 (KAs 3.1, 3.2, 3.3).

4. Control commitment, not spend. By the time an invoice arrives the decision is months old. The commitment-to-accrual-to-actual cycle is what makes cost controllable rather than merely reportable. Test: given a purchase order raised but not yet delivered, say what appears in the cost report this month and what does not — and defend it. Where: Domain 5 (KAs 5.2, 5.4).

5. Compute the indices, and know what they cannot see. CPI and SPI are cheap to produce and easy to over-read. A schedule performance index converges on 1.00 as a late project finishes, whatever the delay; a cost performance index says nothing about work not yet in the baseline. Test: name two situations in which SPI above 1.00 is consistent with a project finishing late. Where: Domain 6 (KAs 6.1, 6.2, 6.4), Domain 4 (KA 4.2).

6. Choose a forecasting method and defend it against the cause of the variance. This is a judgement, not a rule, and it is the single most consequential judgement in the discipline — as PCB-03 – Why 40/40/20 demonstrates, it moves reported revenue. The index-based forecast assumes past performance continues; a bottom-up estimate to complete does not. Which is right depends on whether the variance came from something that is finished or something that is ongoing. Test: name the cause of the current variance, then say which estimate-at-completion method that cause justifies, and why. Where: Domain 6 (KA 6.3), Domain 3 (KA 3.4).

7. Build the network and compute the float without the tool. A professional who cannot run a forward and backward pass by hand cannot tell when the software is wrong, and scheduling software is confidently wrong whenever the logic is. Test: on a ten-activity network, produce early and late dates, total and free float, and the critical path — on paper. Where: Domain 10 (KAs 10.1, 10.2, 10.3).

8. Read the contract for who bears the overrun, and reconcile billing, earned value and revenue to each other. Three numbers describe the same work: what has been certified, what has been earned at budget, and what has been recognised at price. They are rarely equal, they should never be unexplained, and the difference between them is the over- or under-billed position. Test: given the three figures, state the contract asset or liability and say what it means for cash. Where: Domain 7 (KAs 7.1, 7.2, 7.4, 7.5), Domain 2 (KA 2.2).

9. Quantify risk into contingency, and keep management reserve separate. Contingency is quantified, owned by the project and drawn against identified risk. Management reserve is not, and is not the project manager's to spend. Merging them destroys both the forecast and the governance. Test: explain how the current contingency figure was derived and what event would justify a draw against it. Where: Domain 12 (KAs 12.1, 12.2, 12.3), Domain 3 (KA 3.1).

10. Measure adaptive delivery as rigorously as predictive delivery. Increasingly the software, systems and design elements of large programmes run on short feedback cycles with evolving scope. A controls professional who can only measure a fixed baseline is blind to that work, and "it's agile, so we don't measure it" is a controls failure wearing a methodology's clothes. Test: say how you would report cost performance and a completion forecast for a team working from a backlog. Where: Domain 9 (KAs 9.3, 9.5, 9.6), Domain 8 (KA 8.6).

11. Use AI on controls work and remain accountable for the output. The Institute's position: AI proposes; the professional disposes. Nothing produced by a model enters a report until it is explainable, validated and owned by a competent human — which requires knowing what the model was given, what it cannot know, and which part of its output is the part that would be wrong. Test: take an AI-generated forecast narrative and name the two figures you would verify first, and against what. Where: Domain 13 (KAs 13.2, 13.3, 13.5, 13.6).

— 3. How each proposition is evidenced

The propositions are assessed through four-option, single-best-answer items, mostly at the application and analysis cognitive levels, in scenarios that cross domains deliberately — because propositions 6, 8 and 11 are not separable from the others in practice. No formula sheet is provided: selecting the right formula is part of proposition 6.

The examination is a sample, not a census. It cannot observe proposition 7 done on paper, or proposition 11 done under time pressure with a real model. What it establishes is that the candidate knows what the right answer looks like and why the plausible wrong ones are wrong. Employers wanting the rest should use the propositions as an interview and development structure; [PCB-06 – Using the Body of Knowledge: a guide for employers](#) sets out how.

— 4. What is not claimed

None of the eleven asserts experience, seniority or results. Eligibility is three years of professional experience in any field, which establishes that a candidate has worked — not that they have worked in project controls. A pass says the propositions were demonstrated against a published standard at a sitting; it does not say they are being practised today, and it predicts no project outcome, salary or promotion.

Nor is the list a maturity model. Nothing claims a professional who can do all eleven is finished; judgement deepens with exposure to work these propositions only describe.

— 5. How this goes wrong

Treating the tests as examination content. The tests in §2 are conversational probes for self-audit and interviews. They are not sample items, are drawn from no item bank, and answering them well predicts nothing about a sitting.

Reading proposition 7 as nostalgia. Nobody schedules a programme by hand. The proposition is about being able to tell when the tool is wrong, which requires having done it by hand often enough to recognise a result that cannot be right.

Using the list as a job description. A competence claim is not a role. A real role weights the propositions by what the project needs — a graduate planner and a controls manager on the same programme should be strong in different ones. That mapping is an employer's judgement, not the Institute's.

— Related

- [PCB-01 – The Project Controls Body of Knowledge – executive summary](#) — what the credential asserts and its four limits
- [PCB-02 – The thirteen domains at a glance](#) — the domains and knowledge areas cited against each proposition
- [PCB-03 – Why 40/40/20 – the weighting and what it claims](#) — why propositions 1, 2 and 8 carry the weight they do

- [PCB-06 – Using the Body of Knowledge: a guide for employers](#) — turning these propositions into interviews and development plans
- [CMP-03 – PCL-AI: the fourteen competencies](#) — the formal competency set these propositions express

— Sources and standards

- PCL-AI Body of Knowledge, first authored draft ([docs/bok/](#)), August 2026: the per-domain learning objectives, from which the propositions and their knowledge-area references are drawn.
- PCI Canonical Facts ([docs/publication-framework/00-framework/CANONICAL-FACTS.md](#)), verified August 2026: §4.4 eligibility, §7 the fourteen PCL-AI competencies, §10 the house formulations quoted in proposition 11.

IAS 37 is named in proposition 2 as the standard governing provisions; its principle is described in the Institute's own words in the Body of Knowledge and is not reproduced here. No edition is cited, because none was verified for this document.

— Status and version

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How the Body of Knowledge was built

The authoring order, the evidence rule, the arithmetic discipline and the gates a chapter must survive

VERSION 1.0 · DRAFT
2026-08-04

PROJECT CONTROLS INSTITUTE GLOBAL, INC.
AI proposes. The professional disposes.

— Summary

A body of knowledge is only worth as much as its method. This document sets out how the PCL-AI Body of Knowledge was authored: the style spine that fixed notation before content, the sequence in which the thirteen domains were written and why, the per-knowledge-area completion checklist, the four-way classification of every claim, the arithmetic verification rule, and the review gates a chapter must pass — including what is still unfinished.

— About this document

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How the Body of Knowledge was built

In one paragraph. A body of knowledge is only worth as much as its method. This document sets out how the PCL-AI Body of Knowledge was authored: the style spine that fixed notation before content, the sequence in which the thirteen domains were written and why, the per-knowledge-area completion checklist, the four-way classification of every claim, the arithmetic verification rule, and the review gates a chapter must pass — including what is still unfinished.

Who this is for. Practitioners deciding how seriously to take the framework, subject-matter experts considering reviewing it, and anyone building a body of knowledge of their own who would rather not rediscover the failure modes.

— 1. The problem a body of knowledge has to solve

Authority is the whole problem. A framework that decides whether someone passes an examination cannot borrow its authority from the confidence of its prose. It has to be built so that a hostile expert can find the joins: where a claim is a standard's requirement, where it is the Institute's recommendation, where competent practitioners legitimately differ, and where a number came from.

A second problem sits underneath. A reference this size cannot be written in one pass by one person, and material written in parallel drifts — the same symbol means two things by chapter nine, the same concept is defined three times in slightly different words. A candidate who meets **PV** as Planned Value in one domain and present value in another has been set up to fail an item testing neither. Both problems are solved before writing, not after.

— 2. The style spine — fixing the conventions before the content

The first document authored was not a domain. It was the style spine, which fixes the conventions and binds every domain to them.

Terminology. A term is defined once and used identically everywhere; silent redefinition in a later chapter is a defect, not an inconsistency. Terms a domain introduces join the shared glossary in a consolidation pass rather than living locally.

The symbol table. One table of symbols with units, seeded up front even for notation first used deeply in later domains, so the classical and agile treatments of earned value share one notation. Genuine clashes are resolved by explicit rule: **PV** denotes Planned Value in earned-value contexts and present value in discounting contexts, and discounting contexts must write "present value" in words or **PV(x)** so the two never collide on a page.

The worked-example format. Five lines, every time: setup with the given data; the formula with each variable named and its unit; the substitution shown explicitly; the result with unit and rounding; and an interpretation of what the number means for the decision. Where a computation is inherently tabular — a network forward and backward pass, a multi-scenario comparison — a table

replaces the first four lines. The interpretation is never optional, because a number a reader cannot act on has not been taught.

Figure specifications. Every figure carries a number on the Domain.KA pattern, a caption, the underlying data so it is reproducible, and a render-ready description. A figure whose data is not stated cannot be checked.

The item format. Four options, one key, and a rationale saying why the key is right and why each distractor is wrong, tagged with topic number and cognitive level. Distractors are the results of common errors, never filler.

— 3. The authoring order, and why it is not one to thirteen

The domains were written in a sequence dictated by dependency, not numbering. The four finance domains came first, locking the notation and worked-example style on material where precision is least forgiving; the project management domains inherited it. The agile domain was authored **after** earned value, because agile cost forecasting reuses the earned-value machinery on variable scope and would otherwise have invented a parallel notation for the same arithmetic. The AI domain was authored **last**, so its workflows could cross-reference the domains they operate on rather than describing AI in the abstract — which is why Domain 13's largest knowledge area is a systematic pass across the earlier domains rather than a survey of tools.

— 4. The evidence rule — four kinds of statement, each marked

Every claim is one of four things, and the reader is told which. A **fact** is verifiable and, where it matters, attributed to a named framework. A **recommended practice** is what the Institute advises, stated as advice. A **professional judgement** is a point where competent practitioners legitimately differ — said so explicitly, with the grounds for choosing given rather than withheld. A **PCI interpretation** is the Institute's position, labelled as the Institute's.

Two absolute rules govern sources. **Name real frameworks; never fabricate.** IFRS 15, IAS 1, IAS 2, IAS 16, IAS 23, IAS 37 and IFRS 16; the PMBOK Guide and AACE's Total Cost Management framework; ISO 31000 and ISO/IEC 17024; the Agile Manifesto, the Scrum Guide, Kanban and Lean are named where relevant, and no clause number, page reference or quotation is invented. **Never reproduce protected text.** A standard's principle is explained in the framework's own words — "under IAS 37 a provision is recognised when..." — and its wording, tables, diagrams and question banks are never pasted. Every example, table, figure and item is original.

A third rule governs the AI material: describe real capabilities and their limits — hallucination, data quality, bias, confidentiality, auditability — mark evolving capabilities as evolving, and never hype. What makes all of it enforceable is the blanket prohibition on fabrication: no invented quotations, case studies, company names, project data, survey results or statistics. A plausible-looking citation that was not consulted is a conduct matter, not a style error.

— 5. Arithmetic, jurisdiction and language

Every calculation is independently recomputed by someone other than its author, and numerical items get two reviewers. Units, currency, period and rounding are stated; the substitution

is shown, not only the result; and where an answer depends on an assumption, the assumption is named in the same breath as the answer. Rounding is fixed by convention — money to the whole currency unit unless the topic needs cents, ratios to two decimal places, percentages to one. A chapter containing an unverified calculation is rejected at gate.

No jurisdiction's legal, tax or accounting treatment is presented as universal. Where treatment varies, the framework says so and teaches the principle; where an example needs a legal frame, the frame is stated as an assumption of the example. **British English throughout**, acronyms expanded on first use.

— 6. The per-knowledge-area completion checklist

A knowledge area is not finished when it is long. It is finished when every applicable line of a published checklist is satisfied: a precise definition and purpose for each topic with the real standard named; the underlying principle; every formula stated with each variable and unit defined; at least one fully worked example in the five-line format with the numbers re-checked; a second example or mini-case for any non-trivial topic; at least one numbered figure specification; common pitfalls; a treatment of how AI assists that area and where it must not be trusted; a key-terms box; three to six sample items with rationales and level tags; two to four self-check questions with answers; and cross-references by number.

That is what makes depth auditable. "Does this knowledge area have a worked example whose numbers add up?" is a question with an answer; "is this chapter deep enough?" is not.

— 7. The gates, and what fails at them

Every chapter passes a fixed sequence of reviews before it is treated as content: pattern conformance, competency alignment, technical accuracy, calculation verification, source verification, originality, style, legal and company-mention review, diagram and table review, accessibility, cross-reference integrity, item validation, and final editorial approval. A reviewer never reviews their own draft; one chapter has one owner and one file.

Four things fail at gate regardless of quality elsewhere: a placeholder citation, an unresolved calculation, duplicated prose, and generic filler. Length is explicitly not an acceptance criterion — page count is an output check, never a writing method, and no phase may be skipped to meet one.

— 8. What is not yet done

Three things are outstanding, and the framework is published saying so.

Subject-matter-expert review. Every domain is a **first authored draft**: it has passed the internal gates in §7 but not independent subject-matter-expert review, and until it has, it is not final certification content. Panel: [\[CONFIRM: the number of subject-matter experts on the first-edition review panel and their disciplines\]](#). Completion: [\[CONFIRM: date subject-matter-expert review of the first edition completes\]](#).

The job-task analysis. The blueprint's sampling has not been validated against practitioners' actual work. That study will confirm item counts — which is why no item count is published anywhere — and will test the group weightings defended in [PCB-03 – Why 40/40/20](#).

Standard setting. The pass mark configured on the platform is sixty-five per cent; the definitive standard will be set by a modified-Angoff study, a documented judgement about what a minimally competent professional must demonstrate.

Publishing a method with its gaps visible invites the objection that the framework is unfinished, which it is. The alternative — a confident framework whose gaps surface after the first cohort has paid — is the reason certification bodies are distrusted. A reader who can see which parts are settled can challenge the parts that are not, and that challenge is worth more than the appearance of completeness.

— Related

- [PCB-01 – The Project Controls Body of Knowledge – executive summary](#) — what the material built this way claims
- [PCB-02 – The thirteen domains at a glance](#) — the domain and knowledge-area structure this method produced
- [PCB-04 – What a project controls professional must know](#) — the propositions the framework was built to support
- [EXB-04 – How items are written, reviewed and retired](#) — the item-development standard that continues from §2
- [EXB-06 – Job-task analysis: where the blueprint gets its authority](#) — the outstanding study named in §8

— Sources and standards

- The Style Spine — Conventions of This Reference ([docs/bok/00-style-spine.md](#)), August 2026: §1 scope and weighting, §3 the seed glossary, §4 the master symbol table and notation-clash rule, §5 the worked-example format, §6 figure specifications, §7 language and rounding conventions, §8 the item format, §9 citation rules, §10 the per-knowledge-area checklist.
- PCL-AI Body of Knowledge, first authored draft and its README ([docs/bok/](#)), August 2026: the authoring order and the per-domain draft status.
- PCI Editorial Charter ([docs/books/EDITORIAL_CHARTER.md](#)), August 2026: §3 the non-negotiable quality rules, §6 concurrent-authoring and file-ownership rules, §7 the chapter quality gates, §8 phase gates, §10 the definition of done.
- Examination Blueprint ([docs/downloads/examination-blueprint.md](#)), August 2026: §5, the job-task analysis and modified-Angoff commitments.

The standards named in §4 are named as frameworks the Body of Knowledge references and explains in its own words. No edition, clause or wording is cited here, because none was verified for this document.

— Status and version

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PCB-06 · BODY OF KNOWLEDGE — EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Using the Body of Knowledge: a guide for employers

Role design, hiring and development built on a published framework rather than a job-advert template

VERSION 1.0 · DRAFT

2026-08-04

PROJECT CONTROLS INSTITUTE GLOBAL, INC.

AI proposes. The professional disposes.

— Summary

What a hiring manager can and cannot conclude from a PCL-AI credential, and how to use the underlying thirteen-domain framework for three jobs it does well: writing a role specification that describes competence rather than tools, structuring an interview that tests judgement, and assessing a controls function's capability gaps with a weighted coverage measure. Includes a worked gap assessment and a usable checklist.

— About this document

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Using the Body of Knowledge: a guide for employers

In one paragraph. This document explains how to use the thirteen-domain framework behind the PCL-AI credential for three jobs it does well: writing a role specification that describes competence rather than tools, structuring an interview that tests judgement, and assessing a controls function's capability gaps with a weighted coverage measure. It includes a worked gap assessment and a checklist.

Who this is for. Heads of project controls, PMO leads, engineering and commercial directors, and the hiring managers and HR business partners who write the specification and sit on the panel.

— 1. What the credential tells you before you use the framework

A PCL-AI holder has demonstrated competence against a published thirteen-domain framework, at a published standard, in one ninety-minute examination scored criterion-referenced rather than on a curve. The propositions they claim to be able to act on are in [PCB-04](#); the limits on that claim — point-in-time validity, no accreditation, no outcome guarantee, separation from membership grades — are in [PCB-01 – The Project Controls Body of Knowledge – executive summary](#) §5, and should be read before relying on it.

Three points bear specifically on hiring. **Eligibility is three years' professional experience in any field**, not three years in project controls, so sector and domain experience remain yours to assess. **One route requires no examination**: of the three published routes — standard, founding member, honorary fellow — the honorary route involves no sitting, so verify which route earned a credential that matters to a decision ([CER-04 – Routes into PCI: standard, founding, honorary](#)). And **PCI owns the standard and the examination while Certuvo is the separate official training partner**; the certification decision is independent of who prepared the candidate, or whether anyone did.

— 2. Using the domains as a role specification

Most controls specifications describe software, which selects for tool familiarity and produces a role rewritten every time the tool changes. A published framework lets you specify competence and treat the tool as a training item.

The method takes about an hour. Mark each of the thirteen domains **required**, **supporting** or **not applicable**; then for each required domain name the artefact the post-holder owns, its frequency, and its reviewer. That last step turns a framework into a specification. "Domain 6 required" tells a candidate nothing; "owns the monthly earned value report across fourteen control accounts, published to the project board by working day five, reviewed by the controls manager" tells them exactly what they are applying for.

A pattern for three common posts — a starting point, not a standard:

Post	Required domains	Supporting	Typical owned artefact
Cost engineer	1, 3, 5, 6	2, 7, 11, 12	Monthly cost report and commitment register
Planner / scheduler	3, 6, 10, 12	8, 9, 5	Baselined and progressed schedule, critical-path narrative
Controls manager	3, 4, 5, 6, 10, 12	all remaining	Integrated monthly report and the estimate at completion

Two rules keep this honest. **Do not require all thirteen domains for every post** — a specification requiring everything selects for candidates willing to overstate and leaves the role impossible to develop into. And **do not use the examination group weights as a role weighting**: forty per cent examination weight on finance is not forty per cent of a cost engineer's week.

— 3. Using the framework in hiring

A domain map beats a competency form as an interview structure, because it produces questions with right answers. Use one probe per required domain — the probes in [PCB-04 §2](#) are written for this and share a shape worth copying: give a situation and a little data, then ask what the candidate would do next and why. One who names the cause of a variance before selecting a forecasting method is demonstrating judgement; one who names a formula is demonstrating recall.

Three additions earn their place on any panel. **Ask for the working, not the tool** — "show me how you would find total float on this ten-activity network" cannot be answered from a template. **Ask one question about being wrong** — "tell me about a forecast you defended that turned out optimistic: what did you miss, and what changed afterwards?" There is no correct answer; you are assessing whether the candidate treats a forecast as a position they own. **Ask one AI question and score the governance, not the enthusiasm** — "you have an AI-generated variance narrative; which two figures do you verify before it goes to the board, and against what?" Do not ask candidates to reproduce examination content: sample items are published study material, live content never is.

— 4. Worked example — a capability gap assessment

Illustrative figures. A management heuristic, not a PCI instrument — the Institute publishes no such index. A controls function of nine people. For each domain the head of function records how many of the nine can work **unsupervised** in it: one deliberately blunt judgement made in a single session, not a survey. Group A: D1 = 2, D2 = 1, D3 = 7, D4 = 6. Group B: D5 = 8, D6 = 5, D7 = 4, D8 = 6, D9 = 2, D10 = 7, D11 = 1, D12 = 4. Group C: D13 = 1. Figures computed unrounded, shown to one decimal place.

Step 1 — unweighted coverage. Competent person-domains = $16 + 37 + 1 = 54$; slots = $13 \times 9 = 117$. Unweighted coverage = $54 \div 117 = 46.2\%$

Step 2 — coverage by group, the mean count across the group's domains, over the nine people. Group A = $(2 + 1 + 7 + 6) \div 4 = 4.000 \rightarrow 4.000 \div 9 = 44.4\%$ Group B = $(8 + 5 + 4 + 6 + 2 + 7 + 1 + 4) \div 8 = 4.625 \rightarrow 4.625 \div 9 = 51.4\%$ Group C = $1 \div 1 = 1.000 \rightarrow 1.000 \div 9 = 11.1\%$

Step 3 — the weighted index, at the published group weights of 0.40, 0.40 and 0.20. $\text{Index} = (0.40 \times 0.4444) + (0.40 \times 0.5139) + (0.20 \times 0.1111) = 0.1778 + 0.2056 + 0.0222 = 40.6 \%$

That sits 5.6 percentage points below the unweighted 46.2 per cent, because the thinnest coverage — one person in nine in Domain 13 — is where a fifth of the framework's weight rests on a single domain. The headline number flatters the function; the weighted one does not.

Step 4 — two development options, each adding four person-domain competencies.

Option 1 — four people developed in Domain 13, taking D13 from 1 to 5. $\text{Group C} = 5 \div 9 = 55.6 \%$; $\text{Index} = 0.1778 + 0.2056 + (0.20 \times 0.5556) = 49.4 \%$

Option 2 — two people in Domain 1 and two in Domain 2, taking D1 from 2 to 4 and D2 from 1 to 3. $\text{Group A} = (4 + 3 + 7 + 6) \div 4 = 5.000 \rightarrow 5.000 \div 9 = 55.6 \%$; $\text{Index} = (0.40 \times 0.5556) + 0.2056 + 0.0222 = 45.0 \%$

Option 1 moves the index by 8.9 percentage points, option 2 by 4.4 — **exactly twice the movement for the same training effort**, because the twenty per cent AI weight rides on one domain while the forty per cent finance weight spreads across four.

The warning that makes this usable. That doubling is an artefact of the arithmetic, not a finding about your team: the index is twice as sensitive to Domain 13, which is not to say the training is twice as valuable to your projects. If the live problem is a disputed revenue position, option 2 is the right decision and the index the wrong instrument. Use it to find where you are thin, never to choose what to do about it.

— 5. Using the framework for development

Find the single points of failure first. A domain covered by one person is a resilience problem before it is a capability problem. Here that is Domains 11 and 13 — and business process cycles is the one most functions never think to develop, because it looks like finance's job until an invoice dispute proves otherwise.

Set development against artefacts, not courses. "Understands earned value" is unassessable. "Produces the monthly estimate at completion for two control accounts, reviewed by the controls manager, for three consecutive months" has a completion test; [CAR-07 – Building a portfolio of evidence](#) covers how an individual records it.

Sponsor certification deliberately. An examination validates knowledge; it does not substitute for the development above. Fees are route-dependent and discountable: [\[CONFIRM: examination fee — platform seeds USD 500, legacy candidate pack states USD 350\]](#). Budget also for recertification on a three-year cycle with its mandatory AI-currency component; the student portal shows a target of thirty hours of continuing professional development per cycle, but [\[CONFIRM: the binding CPD requirement, to be published with the recertification rules\]](#).

— 6. What not to use the framework for

Not as a pay scale — PCI publishes no salary data, and any figure attributed to the Institute today is not ours. **Not to screen out non-certified candidates** — its hiring value is the structure it gives your questions, which works identically on people who hold nothing. **Not as accreditation, to your client** — "our team is PCI-certified" is accurate; implying accredited or government-

recognised certification is not. **Not for the sibling credentials** — it is PCL-AI only, and no blueprint exists yet for PFL-AI or PML-AI.

— 7. Checklist

- [] Every open post marks each of the thirteen domains required, supporting or not applicable
- [] Every required domain names its artefact, frequency and reviewer; no post requires all thirteen
- [] Group weights are not being used as a role or workload weighting
- [] The interview has one judgement probe per required domain, plus one "being wrong" question
- [] The AI question scores governance and verification, not tool enthusiasm
- [] Team coverage is recorded per domain, with single points of failure flagged
- [] Development objectives are artefacts produced and reviewed, not courses attended
- [] Any credential relied on has been verified, including which route earned it
- [] No accreditation, recognition or outcome claim is being made on PCI's behalf

— Related

- [PCB-01 – The Project Controls Body of Knowledge – executive summary](#) — what the credential asserts and its limits
- [PCB-02 – The thirteen domains at a glance](#) — the domain map used for the specification method in §2
- [PCB-04 – What a project controls professional must know](#) — the probes to build an interview from
- [CMP-10 – Assessing competence – evidence, rubrics, moderation](#) — a rigorous alternative to the heuristic in §4
- [CER-04 – Routes into PCI: standard, founding, honorary](#) — why route verification matters in §1
- [CAR-07 – Building a portfolio of evidence](#) — the individual counterpart to the development plan in §5

— Sources and standards

- PCL-AI Body of Knowledge, first authored draft ([docs/bok/](#)), August 2026: the thirteen domains and sixty-one knowledge areas used throughout.
- Examination Blueprint ([docs/downloads/examination-blueprint.md](#)), August 2026: §2, the group weights applied in §4; §6, the blueprint's published limits, including that it guarantees nothing about outcomes.
- PCI Canonical Facts ([docs/publication-framework/00-framework/CANONICAL-FACTS.md](#)), verified August 2026: §2.1 accreditation wording, §4 examination configuration and recertification, §4.3 the unresolved fee conflict, §4.4 eligibility, §5 application routes, §6 membership grades.

ISO/IEC 17024 is named as the personnel-certification standard the framework is developed with reference to. No edition, clause or wording is cited, because none was verified for this document. The capability assessment in §4 uses illustrative figures and represents no real organisation or team.

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